

into trouble accessing your MSN account. Switching over to a new account is a lot less painful if you have your contacts list handy. The current version of the messenger client (3.6 or later) will let you save your contact list as a .ctt file. You can do this from **File > Save Contact List**.

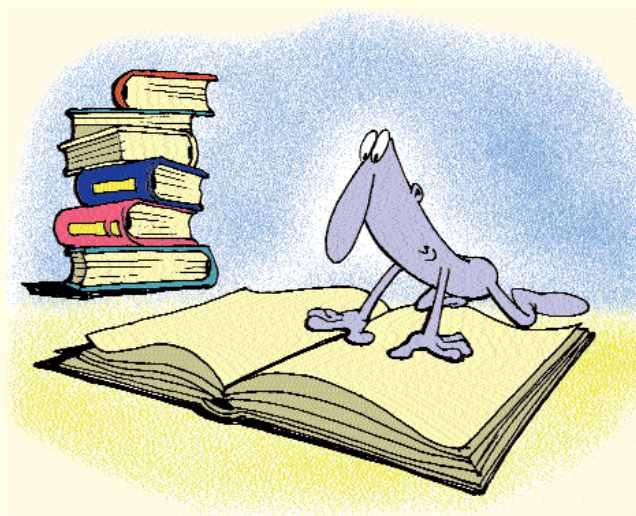
This can be later imported using the **File > Import Contacts** option.

Blocking persons

Sometimes blocking is a very good option to get rid of overbearing friends. If one wishes to do so, simply go to **Tools > Options > Privacy** (for MSN Messenger) and select the person to be blocked. Block and delete will permanently remove the contact from your list and you also have options to remain invisible or offline.

Quick access to received files

When you receive files using MSN Messenger they automatically download to \My Documents\Messenger Service Received Files folder in Windows 98/Me and \Documents and Settings\username\My Documents\Messenger Received Files in Windows 2000. Instead of opening Windows Explorer and browsing to the folder each time, you can access the file faster through MSN itself. Just go to **File > Open Received Files** and the folder where the files are located automatically opens.



BROWSING

Saving Web pages

If you often feel the need to save copies of Web pages, use Internet Explorer to save all the elements of the page in a single .mht file. Go to **File > Save as** and in the Save as type option select Web Archive, Single File (*.mht).

Managing your bookmarks

Bookmark interesting Web sites that you want to revisit. You can further organise your favourite Web pages according to the content, for instance, music, humour, troubleshooting, leisure and so on. Go to **Favorites > Add to Favorites** and select the New Folder option to save the Web page. You can also move or modify your bookmarks from the **Favorites > Organise Favorites** option.

Restricting access

An increasing number of Web sites disseminate adult content but it's possible to restrict viewing of such sites using Internet Explorer

instead of relying on a third-party software such as NetNanny. Go to **Tools > Internet Options > Content > Content Advisor**. Set the level of protection you want and assign a password so that the level of protection cannot be changed.

Smarter surfing

It's no use twiddling your thumbs waiting for a Web page to load. Open multiple browser windows and start getting used to surfing with many pages at one time. This saves time and you can avoid some of the Web traffic blues too. Using a browser such as NetCaptor will ensure that the multiple windows don't clutter your taskbar and are instead placed as tabs within the browser itself.

Autocomplete URLs

You don't always have to type the complete URL to open a site. IE has an autocomplete feature that lets you type the name of

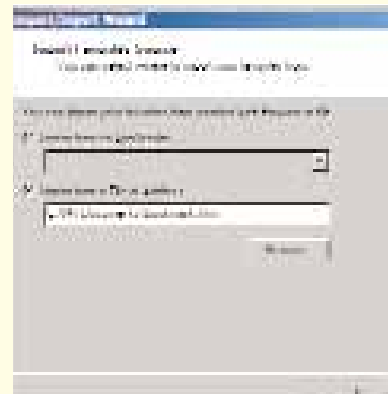
the Web site and press [Ctrl] + [Enter] (only if the Web site ends in .com). For a frequent surfer, exercising this option saves a lot of time.

Autocomplete data

Many browsers such as Netscape and IE let you autocomplete the Web site name as well as the data entered in the previously visited Web sites. User names and passwords need to be entered just once and on your next visit the browser automatically fills in the required fields. This is a timesaver if you are browsing multiple sites—your next visit to the site will not require you to type the data all over again.

Importing bookmarks

If you'd like to import bookmarks from one browser to another, go to **File > Import and Export** and the wizard



Bookmark favourite sites

will guide you through the process. This gives you the same set of links organised in the same manner in another browser.

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